

Izael Effemberg

São Paulo 01413-100, Brazil | izaelecosta@gmail.com | 11983639080 | [LinkedIn](#)

Profile

Senior Product and Technology Leader with 13+ years of experience building and scaling platform, fintech, and infrastructure products across a wide range of organizational contexts — from global consulting and high-growth scale-ups to regulated financial services and enterprise transformation environments. With a strong academic foundation in **Computer Science** and an early career as a software engineer, I bring a builder mindset to product leadership, combining technical depth, product strategy, and hands-on execution.

My career started at **ThoughtWorks**, where I built a strong foundation in software delivery, agile execution, and consulting in complex environments. I then expanded into product leadership roles at **iFood**, **Creditas**, **WillBank-**, and **Stone**, leading platform and financial product initiatives at scale. Later, at **Vertigo/VeeCode**, I combined product, platform, and strategic consulting, working closely with large enterprise clients such as **Itaú**, **Banco Master**, **Credsystem**, and **P&G**. Most recently, at **Sem Parar**, I lead a ~50-person product and engineering tribe, directly managing 5 Product Managers across critical domains such as payments, connectivity, authentication, data enrichment, and operational automation.

Across these experiences, I have developed a strong ability to operate effectively across **different organizational cultures** — from engineering-led and product-centric companies to consulting-driven, transformation-oriented, and highly regulated businesses. This has made me particularly effective at leading through ambiguity, aligning senior stakeholders, scaling teams, and turning complex technical capabilities into products that drive clear business outcomes.

Professional Experience

Senior Group Product Manager - Technical, Sem Parar Corpay, São Paulo

Oct 2025

Responsibilities

- Lead a ~50-person tribe across product and engineering, with direct management of **5 Product Managers (2 Staff, 2 Senior, 1 Junior)**, strengthening organizational maturity, leadership capability, and execution quality across multiple squads.
- Own the **vision, strategy, roadmap, and operating priorities** for a critical platform and connectivity portfolio that powers core monetization and transaction-enablement journeys across the business.
- Oversee strategic product domains central to company performance, including **debt inquiry, authentication, data enrichment, payments, settlement, document issuance, and operational automation**.
- Translate business priorities into scalable platform and product capabilities, aligning commercial goals, technical architecture, operational efficiency, and customer experience.
- Lead internal and financial products with direct impact on **revenue, conversion, cost efficiency, service reliability, and operational performance**, including integrations with **banks, acquirers, and government agencies**.
- Drive complex **cross-functional and cross-company initiatives** in close partnership with Engineering, Data, Operations, Finance, and Growth, managing prioritization, dependencies, governance, and rollout in highly regulated and operationally intensive environments.
- Operate hands-on across **discovery, product strategy, prioritization, business case development, delivery oversight, and performance management**, turning complex technical challenges into scalable business outcomes.
- Build the operating cadence for the tribe, raising the bar on decision-making, accountability, and execution across teams with different maturity levels.

Impact / Results

- Led a strategic portfolio responsible for core monetization capabilities, directly influencing **revenue, conversion, customer experience, and operational resilience**.
- Reduced **credit card transaction costs by 20%** through payment flow optimization, acquirer strategy improvements, and stronger operational efficiency.
- Reduced **team turnover by 80%**, significantly improving retention, team stability, and long-term organizational effectiveness.

- Established stronger governance across cross-tribe initiatives, increasing execution predictability, prioritization clarity, and alignment across squads and stakeholders.
- Improved reliability and efficiency across critical payment, automation, and integration flows, reducing friction in core operational and revenue-generating journeys.
- Elevated the maturity of the product organization under my leadership, improving decision quality, delivery consistency, and the connection between deep technical execution and business impact.

Principal Consultant and Head of Product, Vertigo Tecnologia, São Paulo

Jun 2024 to Oct 2025

- Led strategic product and technology programs for major clients including **P&G, Banco Master, Sankhya, Itaú, and Credsystem**, operating across different organizational contexts ranging from enterprise transformation to regulated financial services and digital platform modernization.
- Directed complex cross-functional initiatives spanning **cloud modernization, mobile platform redesign, technical integration, internal platform enablement, and API/platform strategy**, coordinating 20+ squads across multiple workstreams.
- Shaped end-to-end product and technical strategies, translating business priorities into scalable solutions across **cloud-native architectures, internal developer platforms, API ecosystems, developer portals, mobile abstractions, and data-intensive platforms**.
- Designed organizational and technical blueprints for client teams, defining **operating models, team structures, capability maps, system boundaries, and governance mechanisms** to improve autonomy, scalability, and execution effectiveness.
- Founded and scaled Vertigo's **Technical Delivery Management (TDM)** capability, establishing a stronger operating model for execution across the company's portfolio and embedding observability, governance, KPI-based management, and delivery discipline at scale.
- Partnered closely with product, engineering, and executive leadership to evaluate architectural trade-offs, manage complex dependencies, and accelerate the rollout of strategic internal platforms and business-critical initiatives.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to senior stakeholders, translating complex technical and organizational challenges into structured execution plans with clear milestones, risk mitigation strategies, and decision-making frameworks.

Impact / Results

- Reduced delivery lead time by **40%** by implementing a system-oriented execution framework and streamlining interfaces across teams, functions, and delivery layers.
- Improved release quality and platform uptime by **60%** through the introduction of unified observability practices, stronger operational governance, and more robust incident response mechanisms.
- Designed and deployed post-M&A technical architectures that enabled platform consolidation, reduced operational fragmentation, and accelerated go-to-market across business units.
- Increased execution predictability and organizational alignment across large-scale client programs by introducing clearer governance, ownership models, and cross-team operating rhythms.
- Strengthened Vertigo's ability to deliver complex platform and modernization programs by building a repeatable execution model that scaled across clients and technical contexts.

Principal Technical Product Manager, Stone, São Paulo

Sept 2023 to Jun 2024

Owned strategy, architecture alignment, and delivery for Data Engineering platform within Stone's Foundation Platform, covering messaging infrastructure, database orchestration, and developer tooling. Collaborated with engineering leads to design cloud-native systems, including Kafka pipelines and PostgreSQL clusters, emphasising performance and reliability. Championed internal tools adoption by launching developer discovery efforts and defining north-star KPIs. Created a unified technical roadmap, aligning squads on architecture goals while identifying delivery bottlenecks.

- Reduced platform SLA violations by 30% through architecture refinements.
- Enhanced developer productivity, boosting self-service platform adoption.
- Increased reliability of critical infrastructure services, accelerating product delivery.

Head of Product and Program Management - Platform Engineering, WillBank

May 2022 to Jun 2023

Directed creation of WillBank's inaugural Technical Program Management (TPM) function, overseeing platform portfolio across Reliability, Mobile, Data, and Security. Designed TPM career architecture and operating model, managing 6 direct and 53 indirect reports. Established vision, multi-year roadmap, OKRs, and KPIs for platform engineering, ensuring accountability and measurable outcomes.

- Implemented agile delivery strategy, enhancing dependency management and stakeholder communications across 5 business units.
- Conducted product discovery with Software and Data Engineering teams, prioritising solutions based on developer feedback.
- Developed internal platforms like Customer Data Platform (CDP), promoting self-service capabilities and scalability.
- Led data instrumentation initiatives, creating a taxonomy and event pipeline for enhanced analytics.

Staff Technical Program Manager - Mobile Platform Engineering, Creditas

Apr 2021 to Apr 2022

Oversaw Mobile Platform tribe as Staff TPM, supporting programs across 5 Business Units and 9 tribes in Brazil, Mexico, and Spain. Defined objectives, success criteria, and technical KPIs, aligning leadership on priorities and outcomes. Collaborated with engineering leads to redesign mobile architecture, enhancing reliability and developer velocity. Drove technical delivery initiatives for app resilience, coordinating across product, engineering, QA, and business teams. Optimized agile execution, improving cadence and reducing churn. Introduced observability tooling, enhancing platform insights for bug prioritization.

- Increased mobile app rating from 2.1 to 4.2 across app stores.
- Halved change lead time, doubling team's production issue resolution.
- Boosted deployment frequency by 50%, accelerating feature rollout.
- Cut late billing by 32%, saving R\$1.5M through issue detection.

Senior Technical Product Manager - Platform Engineering, iFood

Mar 2020 to Apr 2021

Spearheaded two platform programs enhancing Engineering Standards and Journey Resilience across iFood's largest tribes: Consumer, Logistics, and Restaurants in Brazil, Mexico, and Colombia. Defined vision and technical strategy to boost reliability in critical product flows, driving scale and faster incident recovery. Collaborated with SRE and mobile/backend teams for observability improvements using New Relic and DataDog, enabling real-time issue detection. Managed cross-org roadmap planning and stakeholder communication, aligning teams on platform-wide standards through an RFC policy.

- Increased uptime of critical business journeys by 42%, facilitating over 9M monthly orders.
- Reduced MTTR by 23% through enhanced observability tools and incident response processes.
- Improved driver availability by 10% across key delivery areas via architecture adjustments.

Senior Consultant - Reliability Software Engineer, ThoughtWorks

Jun 2017 to Mar 2020

Led global delivery team across US, UK, Brazil, China, and India, owning technical vision for ThoughtWorks' first Automated Delivery Infrastructure Platform. Designed and implemented a cloud-native CI/CD platform to streamline software delivery, enforce engineering quality, and reduce operational costs. Drove adoption of modern practices like TDD and BDD, embedding them into platform lifecycle for reliable deployments. Collaborated with distributed squads to define architecture and standardize toolchains across environments.

- Reduced internal AWS infrastructure costs by 70% through optimization and automation.
- Transformed internal delivery platform into external product offering, enhancing client value.
- Improved time-to-market by enabling global reusability of engineering practices and tools.

Education

IFTL, São Paulo, São Paulo

Executive Education, Chief Product Officer Mentorship, Jul 2024 to Jan 2025

Universidade Federal de Pernambuco, Recife, Pernambuco

Bachelor Degree, Information Systems and Management, Jan 2018 to Dec 2019

Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Norte, Natal, Rio Grande do Norte

Bachelor of Information Technology. Emphasis: Software Engineering and Innovation, Jan 2014 to Dec 2019

Galicia Educação, São Paulo, São Paulo

Master Business Degree, Relacionamento com Investidor e Governança Corporativa, Mar 2025

Areas of Expertise

- | | | | |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|
| • Team Development and Leadership | • Agile Methodologies | • Stakeholder Management | • Product Vision and Strategy |
| • OKRs and KPIs | • Dependency Management | • Risk Management | • Technical Program Management |
| • Product Analytics | • Product Discovery | • Technology Governance | |

Awards

Global Platinion Hackathon - 2º Place, Boston Consulting Group

Oct 2023 to Oct 2023

Professional Training

Product Leadership, PM3

Mar 2024 to Apr 2025

Product Pricing, Reforge

Jan 2025 to Mar 2025

Product Analytics, PM3

Jan 2024 to Mar 2024

Product Strategy, Reforge

Oct 2025 to Dec 2026

References

Eduardo Matos, Director of Engineering from Cora

+55 19 981429773

Manoela Badia, CPO from Sem Parar Corpay

+5511985661422